Peter Kloss

Front-End Platform Engineer, Design Systems and AI Developer Tooling

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> Front-end platform engineer with 15+ years building what product teams build on: design systems, shared packages and monorepo tooling. At Highspot, led the organization-wide MCP server that gives AI coding agents the design system's contract, used by ~100 people, and built the platform team's agent workflow system. Before that, led front-end architecture for FedNow, the Federal Reserve's instant payment service.

Experience

Highspot

Dec 2024 – Aug 2026

Sr. Software Development Engineer, Polar UI design system team

Seattle, WA

- Led the organization-wide effort to build the polar-ui MCP server, the design system's contract for AI coding agents, so agent-written UI follows the design system, including complex components such as the data table. It worked alongside the Figma MCP and became a standard part of every Cursor and Claude Code setup for front-end work, used by ~100 people across all application teams, design, and product.
- Introduced many of the team's AI development standards: spec-driven development, shared skills and agents checked into the repo, agent context files (CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md), and rules that keep agents on Polar UI components.
- Designed and rolled out an agent workflow system for the platform team, built in TypeScript on Bun: specialist agents and skills turn specs into dependency-mapped plans, where plans and tasks both carry dependencies, so up to 4 developers and their agents know which work is unblocked, claimed, or safe to run in parallel.
- Used that system to build two major components: a streaming Markdown component, and a TanStack-based data table, built after an AG Grid Enterprise license was blocked and defined by 21 specs and 189 requirement documents.
- Built accessible React and TypeScript components (WCAG, ARIA) from Figma designs and design tokens, with end-to-end tests in TestCafe and Playwright and visual regression tests.

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston (FedNow)

2021 – 2024

Lead Front-End Engineer (promoted from Sr. UI Front End Developer)

Boston, MA

- Led front-end architecture across FedNow applications, aligning Product, UX, back-end, QA and security teams on one consistent, scalable approach.
- Cut initial bundle size from over 15 MB to under 1 MB across multiple applications without delaying FedNow's launch, through code splitting and lazy loading, micro-frontends, a new build setup, fewer heavy dependencies, and design system and shared packages rebuilt as tree-shakeable ES modules. A Git plugin flagged oversized modules for further splitting.
- Built and maintained the FedNow design system and shared npm packages, used by FedNow's internal and external applications and its internal platform tools, including several QA applications.
- Wrote front-end standards adopted by 5+ teams, which reduced code review issues, and built a testing harness that raised test coverage across the organization.
- Mentored 20+ developers one-on-one and ran weekly office hours open to every development team.

Pippin Title
2020 – 2021

Senior Front-End Engineer
Boston, MA

- Drove the migration from AngularJS to React while feature work continued.
- Architected and documented a design system on Chakra UI and Styled System.
- Automated generation of React GraphQL queries from the schema with GraphQL Codegen; led the Stripe payments integration.

LinkSquares
2019 – 2020

Senior Front-End Engineer
Boston, MA

- Built a Storybook-documented design system that let the product move to a new look incrementally.
- Moved the app to a GraphQL architecture that generated fully typed fragments, queries and mutations colocated with their React components.
- Built an OCR review widget that flagged words under 90% confidence so clients could correct them quickly.

Sheridan PubFactory
2017 – 2019

Senior Front-End Engineer
Boston, MA

- Built a themeable design system and dynamic templates that let publishing customers create their own themes and layouts from the UI.

Jack Morton Worldwide
2016 – 2017

Senior Front-End Engineer
Boston, MA

- Re-architected Subway's digital menu boards, the agency's top-priority project: dynamically loaded modules and a custom animation library tuned to proprietary hardware, migrated without missing deliverables.

Earlier roles

Harvard Business School Front-End Engineer — 2015 – 2016
Six Red Marbles Software Engineer — 2013 – 2015
Brigham and Women's Hospital UX Engineer — 2009 – 2012

Skills

AI platform	MCP servers (including Figma MCP), Claude Code and Cursor (skills, subagents, hooks, plugins), spec-driven development, multi-agent workflow orchestration
Front end	TypeScript, React, Lit and Web Components, accessibility (WCAG, ARIA), design tokens, TanStack Table, React Query, GraphQL (Apollo, Codegen), Chakra UI, Storybook, Figma
Platform and tooling	Bun, Node.js, monorepos, webpack, Vite, Rollup, changesets, npm publishing, GitHub Actions, Docker, Podman
Testing	Jest, TestCafe, Playwright, visual regression testing

Education

University of Massachusetts Amherst